LENA VARGA-HOLM

Senior Data Engineer

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PROFILE

Senior Data Engineer with 9 years of experience designing, building and operating production batch and streaming data platforms and cloud data warehouses at scale. Experienced with Python, SQL, Airflow, dbt, Kafka, Snowflake and AWS, including large-volume reconciliation, dimensional modelling, data quality standards and warehouse performance optimisation. I build reusable, well-tested pipelines and clear data contracts that analysts and product teams can trust.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Data Engineer - Lukovac Freight Hub d.o.o. (logistics marketplace), Rijeka
03/2022 - present

- Own the ingestion layer of the company data platform: ~140 Airflow DAGs loading from Postgres, MySQL, Salesforce and 3rd-party APIs into Snowflake.
- Migrated approximately 300 stored procedures into 420+ dbt models with tests, documentation, incremental models and slim CI using state:modified in GitHub Actions; reduced the nightly cloud warehouse build from 5h10 to 1h35 and made lineage visible to analysts.
- Introduced data contracts between product teams and the data team (JSON Schema + CI checks), cutting broken-pipeline incidents from ~9/month to ~2/month.
- Built a Kafka-based event pipeline (Kafka Connect + Snowpipe Streaming) for shipment tracking events, ~30M events/day.
- Replaced hourly full-table extracts from PostgreSQL with Debezium CDC into Kafka, reducing replica CPU during loads from approximately 70% to 25%.
- Mentor two mid-level data engineers; run the weekly data platform office hours.
- Participate in the data-platform on-call rotation (1 week in 6).
- Reduced Snowflake spend from approximately $38k/month to $24k/month through warehouse sizing, auto-suspend and removal of unused tables.

Data Engineer - Kovalent Pay (payments startup), Zagreb *09/2019 - 02/2022*

- Built PySpark batch jobs on AWS EMR to reconcile approximately 1.2 TB of daily S3 files against internal ledgers, reducing finance-team manual reconciliation from approximately 3 days to 4 hours per month-end.
- Designed the Redshift warehouse schema (star schema, 30+ fact/dimension tables) used by finance and risk.
- Set up data quality checks with Great Expectations on critical finance tables.
- Wrote internal Python library for S3/Glue catalog access used by 4 teams.

Junior Data Engineer / BI Developer - Adria Retail Group, Split *06/2017 - 08/2019*

- Maintained SSIS packages and T-SQL ETL into an on-prem SQL Server warehouse.
- Built Power BI reports for store operations (40+ stores).
- Migrated 60 nightly SSIS jobs to Python scripts scheduled with cron.

SELECTED PROJECTS

- Open-source contribution – Airflow provider: fixed a pagination bug and added tests in a community provider package; 2 merged pull requests.
- Change Data Capture from PostgreSQL (Lukovac Freight Hub, 2024): replaced hourly full-table extracts with Debezium CDC into Kafka, reducing replica CPU during loads from approximately 70% to 25%.

EDUCATION

MSc Computer Science (Data Science track) - Northgate Technical University, 2017
AWS Certified Data Engineer – Associate | May 2024
Thesis: Incremental materialized views for analytical queries

SKILLS

Languages: Python, SQL, Bash

Data Platforms & Modelling: Airflow, dbt, Spark (PySpark), Kafka, Kafka Connect, CDC, Debezium, Snowflake, Redshift, PostgreSQL, Great Expectations, pytest, dimensional modelling, data contracts, data quality

Cloud, Infrastructure & CI/CD: AWS (S3, EMR, Glue, Lambda, IAM, MSK), Docker, Terraform (basic), GitHub Actions

BI: Power BI, Looker (basic)

LANGUAGES

Croatian (native), English (C1), German (B1)